

made the Apple II dissipate heat without a fan, was to have a stake of ten per cent in the company.

The Apple II was launched at the West Coast Computer Faire amidst great fanfare in 1977. “When the doors to the Faire were thrown open at 10 A.M., the first visitors to stream in found themselves face-to-face with the sleekest, most handsome, most professional-looking personal computer the world had ever seen. And when the guys manning the booth pulled the cases open, the hobbyists, the nerds, media people, and others saw the most advanced motherboard anyone had ever dreamt of. Woz had outdone himself once again, with a design that crammed onto the board sixty-two chips and ICs—an unheard-of achievement. And Jobs’ overbearing demands that every solder connection be done with a neat, attractive straight line gave the workmanship a quality look that was as pleasing and surprising as it was unsurpassed.

People crowded around, unwilling to believe that the electronics in those small boxes could possibly be responsible for creating the dynamic images in vivid color on the giant television screen. Steve Jobs, looking almost dapper in his first suit had to continually whip away the draperies to prove that there was no big computer hidden out of sight.” This is an excerpt from *iCon: Steve Jobs—The Greatest Second Act in the History of Business*, by Jeffrey Young and William Simon, which sums up the fabulous response the Apple II received on its launch. Needless to say, it was a successful machine, success of the highest order. It made Apple’s cash registers overflow, and established Apple as a primary player in the computer business.

Apple III

Ben Parker says to Peter Parker in the Spiderman movie that “With great power comes great responsibility.” This was true in the case of Apple too. However, due to the anti-corporate culture at Apple, it did not take the responsibility seriously. The company began expanding and by 1980, the year of the release of the Apple III, Apple had grown into a large multinational corporation. However,